SpeechGeek Presents



H.I.larious, Vol. 3

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Corey Alderdice
Editor and Publisher

Email:
thegeek@speechgeek.com

248 Arlington Park Dr.
Hot Springs, AR 71901
(888) 742-2028

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Well, folks, it's official. The summer of 2014 is a great time to be a comic genius.

Capping off a career that spanned three decades, professional song parodist "Weird Al" Yankovic accomplished a nearly unheard of feat in July. With song parodies such as "Tacky" and "Word Crimes," playfully mocking tunes by Pharrelll and Robin Thicke, Weird Al's album *Mandatory Fun* debuted at number one on the Billboard Top 200 chart. To put the accomplishment in perspective, this is the first time a comedy album has topped the chart since 1963.

It goes to show you that being true to yourself and being a little weird can be a great thing. Another great thing? A collection of five new hilarious scripts to dazzle and delight audiences everywhere! From madcap mystics and twisted witches to dog whisperers and mixed up contestants, our newest issue of H.I.-larious scripts offers no shortage of opportunities for performers to showcase their silly side.

Best of luck!

Corey Alderdice
Publisher



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The Game Show of Game Shows

by Matt Mills

(After a stereotypical game show theme plays, a clean-cut HOST walks onto the stage.)

HOST. Hello, and welcome everyone to the first episode of "The Game Show of Games Show!" This is the only game show where even the contestants have no clue what's going on. First contestant, tell us about yourself!

BOB. Uh… (*pause)* pass.

HOST. You can't pass yet; the game hasn't even started!

BOB. Oh. How am I supposed to know that?

HOST. Ok, I think that's pretty much all we need to know about you. Moving on! Second contestant tell us about yourself.

BRASHLEY. Well, my name's Brashley. Some of my friends call me Brit, some call me Ash, some just call me Rashy. I once ate an entire pack of Twizzlers while hiding in a tube-slide. I got stuck and the fire department had to come axe me out of there.

HOST. Oh my, well that's—

BRASHLEY. I had just had my first period. And you know, between the pain, the fear, and the Twizzlers…

HOST. (*interrupts)* All right, your time is up! (*murmurs)* Thank goodness. Let's meet our final contestant then, shall we? You, sir, what's your name?

SAMANTHA. Samantha.

HOST. Oh, I'm sorry. You looked like a man to me.

SAMANTHA. That's okay. I look like a man to pretty much everyone.

HOST. So please, tell us about yourself!

SAMANTHA. *(pause)* No.

HOST. Okay! Let's get started then, shall we?

SAMANTHA. Where's the food?

HOST. Excuse me, I'll be asking the questions.

SAMANTHA. I was promised food. Where's the food?

BRASHLEY. There were onion rings in my dressing room.

BOB. What? I didn't get anything!

BRASHLEY. Yeah, well, I brought them, butthead.

HOST. Okay, I think everyone agrees we are done getting to know you. We will now begin the actual show here on "The Game Show of Games Show"! Now, what you are about to see tonight will be a grueling test of not only mental endurance but also mental stamina, mental persistence, mental resignation, and even mental indefatigability.

BOB. *(rings buzzer)* Those all mean the same thing.

HOST. Ooh, I'm so sorry. That will be twelve game show 'Game Points' deducted from Bob's score.

BOB. Hey!

HOST. Let's begin with the first question. Warning: these questions are not for the faint of brain. Here we go. First question: "What would you say if I asked you to tell me about yourself?" Bob, this question is to you.

BOB. Wait. What?

HOST. I'll repeat the question: "What would you say if I asked you to tell me about yourself?"

BOB. But you already asked me about myself.

HOST. Bob. Just for you, I will repeat the question.

BOB. No, I don't need it repeated. It just doesn't make any sense.

HOST. I need an answer, Bob!

BOB. Really?

HOST. Right away!

BOB. (*rushed and confused)* Uh, uh, uh... Pass!

HOST. Okay, moving on to Brashley—or as I call her, Sh! Now the question remains: "What would you say if I told you to tell me about yourself?"

BRASHLEY. Well I once had this cousin who worked at the fair, and we'd always go make fun of him for sweating all over the cookies that he was baking. One day he came to our house and lit everything on fire. Then the next day...

HOST. (*interrupts)* Ooh, I'm sorry to say that is incorrect.

BRASHLEY. You're incorrect!

HOST. False. Last chance goes to Samantha! Samantha: "What would you say if I told you to tell me about yourself?"

SAMANTHA. *(thinks)* I'd say shut up and get away from me, you pervert.

HOST. Ding ding ding! We've got a winner! Seventeen 'Game Points' to Samantha!

SAMANTHA. Oh yeah! Come to papa, baby.

BOB. What? How is that right?!

BRASHLEY. Yeah. My answer was so much better and super intense.

BOB. Yeah.

BRASHLEY. Yeah.

HOST. Moving on to round two! In round two...

(Suddenly, whooping sirens go off.)

HOST. Whoa! We are in for something special today ladies and gentlemen! Those sirens indicate that the second round of tonight's competition will be the "Freestyle Stage of Freestyling!"

BOB. What?

HOST. Each contestant will take the stage for thirty seconds and compete for points!

BRASHLEY. Okay, but how do we get points?

BOB. Yeah, I don't get this at all.

BRASHLEY. Me neither.

SAMANTHA. I'm still hungry.

HOST. I'm sorry you are all incorrect. I am the host so I ask the questions.

Nice try, though. All right, Samantha. Since you won the first round, you get to take the stage first!

SAMANTHA. Do I have to?

HOST. Yes.

SAMANTHA. Can you move the stage closer to me?

HOST. No, we cannot move the ground for you.

SAMANTHA. Not even just a little bit?

HOST. That's not how architecture works, Sammie-Samster. Now take your spot. You have thirty seconds to stop people from thinking you're an embarrassment to society.

SAMANTHA. I'm going to need a lot more time than that.

(SAMANTHA walks onto the stage.)

HOST. Are you ready?

SAMANTHA. No.

HOST. On your mark, get set, go!

(SAMANTHA remains still for a moment, then acts out everything she says...)

SAMANTHA. Hi. I'm hungry. I could eat my own arm. This guy won't give me food. I think he's a fascist. This show is dumb, and—

HOST. Oh, no, I'm so sorry! It looks like your time is up. How unfortunate, just as that was getting... (*beat)* Well, anyway. Bob, it's your turn!

BOB. Me?

HOST. Yes, you.

BOB. Pass.

HOST. I'm sorry there is no passing in the "Freestyle Stage of Freestyling" round.

BOB. Okay, can I just take negative points so you can move on to Brashley?

HOST. I'm sorry; you must take the stage Bob.

BOB. What if I refuse? Huh? What will you do, arrest me?

HOST. Yes. It's in your contract.

BOB. What?

BRASHLEY. What's a contract?

HOST. Take the stage, Bob.

(BOB begrudgingly schleps to the stage.)

BOB. Hi. I'm Bob. And, uh...so...what's the deal with jay walking, huh? It's like...uh...why is it such a big deal? J-walking has to stand for 'just walking' because, uh...that's all you're doing! You're just...walking... what's up with that? Okay, is my time up?

HOST. You still have seven seconds to go!

BOB. Okay. Well, I also think...

HOST. (*interrupts)* Stop stop stop Bob, your time is up! Quit talking and get back behind your podium as we welcome Brashley to the stage!

BRASHLEY. Wooo! Mama, I'm on TV!

(BRASHLEY runs to the stage, flailing excitedly.)

HOST. You do realize you've been on TV this whole time, right?

SAMANTHA. I did it for FOOD!

HOST. Brashley. You're up first! Producers, lay down that beat!

(A beat begins playing. BRASHLEY tries to bounce along to it.)

BRASHLEY. Uh, well…my name is Brashley. I'm not very trashy. I like watching TV and I don't eat carbs! My neighbors try to hate, 'cause all I do is sun bake, but they're just jealous because they're uglier than me. Peace.

HOST. Okay, that was somehow even worse than I imagined. Samantha? What've you got for us?

SAMANTHA. Drop the beat, homeslice.

HOST. Oh, yes. My bad. Consider it dropped…

(The beat drops.)

SAMANTHA. Yo-yo-yo-yo I'm Samantha, quick as a pantha', chuggin' Mylanta 'cause I'm sicka than canca'. If you see me on the street you better run the other way. 'Cause when I get hungry there ain't nothin' else to say, I'm gonna eat ya! Eat ya - eat ya - eat ya, I'm Samantha! Samantha out.

HOST. Wow, all right! That definitely made me uncomfortable for thirty seconds. We now move on to our final contestant of the evening. (*pause)* Oh dear, I already forgot your name. That's how uninteresting you are to me.

BOB. Bob.

HOST. No, my name's Sean.

BOB. No, *my* name's Bob.

HOST. All right, whatever. Our final contestant for tonight will be Flob! Flob, give us your best freestyle rap!

BOB. No.

HOST. What?

BOB. No.

HOST. Just…no?

BOB. Yes.

HOST. You're really not going to do it?

BOB. Nope.

HOST. Well it doesn't get any more freestyle than that! Ladies and gentlemen, we have a winner! Congratulations to Flob!

BOB. Whatever.

BRASHLEY. Are you kidding me?

SAMANTHA. We're done now, right?

BRASHLEY. Why does *he* win?

BOB. Why *did* I win?

HOST. Why did you win?

BOB. Yeah.

HOST. Why did you win?

BOB. …Yes…

HOST. I'll tell you why you won.

BOB. Okay, great.

BRASHLEY. Yeah, but sometimes my mom gets confused and thinks people are stuck in a tiny box in her living room.

HOST. Oh. Well she sounds like a (*beat)* lovely lady. Rashy, your time starts now!

(BRASHLEY performs an overly dramatic interpretive dance…)

BRASHLEY. The mall. So little time, so much shopping. Where? Where did the shoes go? I am hunting. I am predator. I want Starbucks. Cappuccino, frappucinno, danger! Ex-boyfriend. Cinnabon, ex-boyfriend, Cinnabon! I rest.

HOST. Okay, that just happened! I don't think I even need to check with my judges to determine that Brashley has won the second round here on The Game Show of Games Show!

BRASHLEY. YES!

HOST. Bob, your performance was so terrible we will deduct thirty-eight points from your score and our hit men have fired a warning shot outside your parents' house.

BOB. WHAT?!

BRASHLEY. O-M-G, O-M-G, O-M-F-G-L-M-F-A-O, I won! Mom, I won! Hey ex-boyfriend, Kyle! Who's the loser now?

HOST. Bob is.

BOB. Hey!

SAMANTHA. *(laughs)* Bob sucks!

HOST. Ladies and gentlemen, we have finally arrived at the moment you've all been waiting for: the final round. I know! Don't cry—at least not right now. For our third and final round will be the best, most awesomely awesome, most fairly fair test of your competitive capabilities that anyone has ever seen or imagined. Contestants, your task is: (*dramatic pause)* freestyle rapping!

BOB. Oh, you've got to be kidding me.

BRASHLEY. Oh-em-gee!

SAMANTHA. Yes!

BOB. What does rapping have to do with anything?

HOST. Ah, ladies and gentlemen, Bob has stumbled onto the theme of The Game Show of Games Show! What does anything have to do with anything?

BRASHLEY. I don't know, what?

HOST. The universe is full of things that are just things. What separates some things from other things? Do you know?

BOB. Uh…

HOST. I don't! Nor does anyone else.

BRASHLEY. That's so deep.

HOST. Here on the Game Show of Games Show, we turn anything into a non-regulated competition! This is because everything is just stardust floating through space.

BOB. Why did I think doing this show would be a good idea?

BRASHLEY. I did it for the free Evian.

HOST. Flob won tonight because the only thing that is more interconnected, chaotic, and downright nonsensical than the crazy mess of stars we call the universe is this, "The Game Show of Games Show."

BOB. Wow, television execs must be getting really desperate.

BRASHLEY. They're always desperate. Believe me.

HOST. That's it for our show tonight, ladies and gentlemen! Tune in next week to see some more random but equally existent phenomena take place.

BRASHLEY. This guy is so boring.

BOB. Who came up with this show?

SAMANTHA. Time for food!

HOST. Good night America! See you next week on "The Game Show of Games Show."

Fortune Favors

by Jane Nicolaas

ESMERALDA. Come! Come see Esmeralda. I will look into my crystal ball, read your palms, interpret your dreams and tell you your future. The Great Esmeralda's visions always come true!

COOKIES. (*squawks*) Lies.

ESMERALDA. (*beat)* The Great Esmeralda's visions *mostly* come true.

COOKIES. (*squawks*) Mostly lies.

ESMERALDA. Silence, Cookies, or I shall foresee your certain death.

BOSS. (*on the phone*) Look, she's already getting the kids and the house. That woman is not getting alimony as well! You can tell her to drive that beamer up her—

ESMERALDA. As I predicted! Hello, Boss.

BOSS. (*hangs up*) Hello, Esmeralda.

ESMERALDA. I knew you would be coming.

BOSS. Sure you did. Listen—

ESMERALDA. I know why you are here.

BOSS. To fire you.

ESMERALDA. No…that's not it…

BOSS. Yes, it's time. The carnival appreciates your contributions but…

ESMERALDA. (*interrupts)* You cannot fire me today, Boss. I have just begun a new marketing strategy and I have foreseen a big boost in my future profits.

BOSS. What new marketing strategy?

ESMERALDA. They're free fortune samples, care to try one?

BOSS. (*takes small slip of paper and reads*) "You must please yourself to please others." That's not even a fortune. (*sniffs)* Why does this smell like those Chinese cookies?

ESMERALDA. Reduce. Reuse. Recycle.

BOSS. Esmeralda, we simply can't handle all of the complaints.

ESMERALDA. Complaints? Surely you have been misled or perhaps a mistake has been made.

BOSS. I'm afraid not. You are creepy, unfriendly to customers, and don't even get me started about incident reports. We've decided that we are going to replace your tent with a parking lot.

COOKIES. (*squawks*) Sounds about right.

ESMERALDA. Boss, I normally don't do this sort of thing. But I must tell you why you cannot fire me today. Because… (*thinking*)

BOSS. (*annoyed)* Esmeralda…

ESMERALDA. (*stalling)* Because…

COOKIES. (*squawks*) Here it comes!

ESMERALDA. Today is the day you will meet the love of your life!

BOSS. The love of my life?

ESMERALDA. Yes! Here, in this very tent. I have seen it.

BOSS. How could you possibly know that?
ESMERALDA. The Great Esmeralda's visions always—
COOKIES. (*squawks*)
ESMERALDA. —*Sometimes* come true. And in this case, I am certain of it!
BOSS. Well…okay. I will keep your tent open if you introduce me to the love of my life today.
ESMERALDA. Very good. You come back at the end of the day and I will.
BOSS. (*interrupts)* Not so fast! If you're so sure it will happen today, in this very tent, then I will stay here.
ESMERALDA. Very well, but you must not be seen.
BOSS. Why?
ESMERALDA. Please, look at you! No, no, no, you will scare away my customers. (*ushers BOSS out)* You will hide behind this curtain and I will reveal you when the time is right.
BOSS. Fine. I have emails to return anyway. (*exits*)
ESMERALDA. Oh dear, Cookies.
COOKIES. (*squawks*) Start packing.
ESMERALDA. Not so fast, we can make this work. It will simply take some (*beat)* magic. (*bell rings*) Ah, my first guest of the day. I knew you would be coming.
MARGE. Oh my, a real live gypsy! (*snaps a picture*) How exotic!
FRANK. This is a durn waste of time. I can tell you your future, sugarbump: you're gonna waste a lot of money.
ESMERALDA. Let me read your palm. (*checks and finds a ring*) Ah, you are married?
MARGE. Yes, we are. That's AMAZING!
COOKIES. Jigglypuff, you are wearing a wedding ring the size of Texas.
ESMERALDA. Well, perhaps we can change your future, *Marge*.
MARGE. (*gasps*)
FRANK. You've got your name embroidered on your camera bag, Babybuddha.
ESMERALDA. (*studies MARGE'S palm)* I see in your palm that you have a long life line.
MARGE. Do I?
ESMERALDA. Yes…*but*…
MARGE. But, what?
ESMERALDA. Your love line is rather (*beat)* flat. You are dissatisfied with your current life.
MARGE. Am I?
FRANK. Potatoface! Look, a parrot! (*starts poking*) Polly wanna cracker? Polly wanna cracker?
COOKIES. (*squawks*) Frank wanna eyepatch?
ESMERALDA. Yes, Marge. Yes, I see much unhappiness in your future if you do not make a change. I see you crying while making pot roast.
MARGE. Oh god, I already do that!
ESMERALDA. I see you serving Frank a beer while he sinks lower and lower

into the couch.
MARGE. It's already so low!
ESMERALDA. I see you wishing you had chosen differently. Perhaps wishing you could start again, with a new life, a new you and a new (*beat)* Frank?
MARGE. I do. Oh, I do! (*leaves crying*)
FRANK. (*covering his eyes*) Honeysaurus? What happened?
ESMERALDA. I do not protect feelings; I only predict futures. That will be $56.60 for the palm reading. Please feel free to take a fortune sample on your way out.
FRANK. These smell like Chinese food.
ESMERALDA. You are welcome/ (*closes the door*)
BOSS. Esmeralda! What was that? It's no wonder customers complain! You had one leave crying. The other one you poked in the eye!
ESMERALDA. No! Cookies did that.
BOSS. (*phone rings*) Ugh. What? Complete robbery! That woman is a vampire! What does she expect me to do, starve?
ESMERALDA. Well, you seem busy. (*ushers BOSS out of the room*) All right, we'll try a new tactic: love potion!

(*bell rings*)
IVANA. Excuse me, do you have —?
ESMERALDA. Yes! Yes, I do.
IVANA. You don't even know what I was going to ask.
ESMERALDA. Don't I?
COOKIES. (*squawks*) She doesn't.
ESMERALDA. You are in need. This is clear. You have come to me because it is your final chance at happiness. You know you must meet the man of your dreams *now* if you are to have the life you always dreamed of!
IVANA. No, I –
ESMERALDA. (*interrupts)* After all, you're not getting any younger and neither is your baby-making machinery.
IVANA. Hey!
ESMERALDA. The truth is sad, just like you. But, you are in luck! For today I have a very special special: a love potion! A simple vial that identifies your soul mate! Your dream man! Your one and only! The one you *have* to be with or you and I will not survive! (*opens it*) And it works so easily! It only spills on the one you are meant to be with. Watch! (*curtain lifted, throws the vial of liquid on BOSS*)
BOSS. Ah! What was that? It smells like Tilex.
ESMERALDA. (*to BOSS*) Reduce. Reuse. Recycle. (*to IVANA*) My goodness! Your true love, here he stands! Congratulations, that'll be $76.90.
IVANA. I was going to ask if you had change for a $20 so I can park my car.
COOKIES. (*squawks*) Backfire.
ESMERALDA. Well, who needs *that* when you have true love?

IVANA. I'm not into guys.
COOKIES. (*squawks*) Double backfire.
ESMERALDA. Ah, I see. Well then, here is your change.
IVANA. This is only $15.
ESMERALDA. Consider it shipping and handling. Good luck to you and your search for a parking space.
BOSS. Esmeralda!
ESMERALDA. Do not despair, it is like William Shakespeare said: "The corset of true love is never did fasten smoothly."
COOKIES. (*squawk*) Misquote.
BOSS. This is ridiculous. You are fi- (*phone rings*)
ESMERALDA. Finally getting you close to your dream woman? Indeed.
BOSS. (*on the phone*) You have to be kidding me. The beamer is not an option. She didn't even know what it is. She thinks its part of the Star Trek collection!
ESMERALDA. Star Trek collection? (*closes curtain*) Cookies, this is getting serious. We have to – (*bell rings*) Aha! This will be her for sure.
BERTHA. Hi.
ESMERALDA. (*shocked)* AH! (*composes herself)* I mean, ahhhhh, I knew you would be coming, big — I mean — little girl.
BERTHA. I'm just looking.
COOKIES. (*squawks*) So am I.
BERTHA. Mom, hurry up!
(*bell rings*)
ESMERALDA. Ah, I knew your mother would be—
JUDY. (*enters on the phone*) Mmmhmm, hmmm, mmmhmmm.
ESMERALDA. — on the phone.
BERTHA. Do you do readings?
ESMERALDA. Yes, I can read.
COOKIES. (*squawks*) 4th grade level.
BERTHA. Wow, me too!
ESMERALDA. Fascinating. (*to parrot*) What are we to do, Cookies? I cannot marry Boss to fat little girl.
COOKIES. (*squawks*) Start packing.
ESMERALDA. Oh, you are right. It's hopeless. All my years I have dreamed of doing magic for the common folk, of helping them find love and happiness.
BERTHA. Mom! I found paper that tastes like fortune cookies!
JUDY. (*on the phone*) Uh-huh. Uh-huh.
ESMERALDA. Oh, okay, you are right (*pulls curtain back*) Boss, you are right. We are not magical. I only make one more prediction: I predict I am out of a job.
BOSS. (*on the phone*) Outrageous! There is no way!
JUDY. (*on the phone*) Oh, there is so a way! She might not be able to stand up to you, but I certainly can!
ESMERALDA. Are they…?

COOKIES. (*squawk*) On the phone!
BOSS. (*on the phone*) It's robbery!
JUDY. (*on the phone*) It's payback!
ESMERALDA. Boss, she's in the tent.
BOSS. What? (*on the phone*) You're in the tent?
JUDY. (*on the phone*) I came to give you what for in person!
BOSS. (*on the phone*) Well, that's very considerate of you! Not many people come to give me what for in person anymore!
JUDY. (*on the phone*) Yes! They said you were firing the gypsy today so I brought my daughter to see a real live gypsy before you fired her!
BOSS. (*on the phone*) Well, here she is! And here I am! (*BOSS hangs up, turns and finally looks at JUDY, only to be star struck by how beautiful she is.)* …whoa.
JUDY. (*on the phone, finally notices BOSS*) Hubba, hubba. (*hangs up*)
BOSS. What do you say we go and have a little chat in private?
JUDY. Sounds good to me, but don't you need to fire the gypsy first?
BOSS. The who?
ESMERALDA. Me, Boss.
BOSS. Oh. (*looking at ESMERALDA*)
COOKIES. (*squawks)* Moment of truth!
BOSS. Esmeralda!
ESMERALDA. Yes, Boss?
BOSS. Is this the woman you were predicting I'd meet today?
ESMERALDA. (*beat)* Yes. Yes, it is.
BOSS. Wow, that's amazing! You watch the fat little kid. We'll be back later. (*to JUDY)* Shall we?
JUDY. Only if I can see your Star Trek collection.
BOSS. I LOVE YOU!
ESMERALDA. Ah, yes, love is the most beautiful magic of all. Cookies! Do you know what this means?
COOKIES. (*squawks*) Dodged a bullet!
ESMERALDA. And the Great Esmeralda's vision came true!
COOKIES. (*squawk*)
BERTHA. (*reads one last fortune cookie*) "They will all live happily ever after." (*eats it*)
ESMERALDA. I can see that.

The Family Business

by Matt Mills

JIMMY. (*to audience)* Hey guys. I'm Jimmy. Look, if I tell you something, can you keep it a secret? It's just that I don't really have anyone else I can talk to about this, so I'd really appreciate it. You see, my dad is…well…you should really just see for yourself.

DAD. Jimmy, wake up! It's time for your morning session!

JIMMY. Dad, do I really have to do this every day?

DAD. Of course you do! Who is going to take over the *family* business when I'm gone? *Non*-family members? Over my dead body! Jimmy, you're going to be everything I was and more!

JIMMY. You're making it sound a lot like you're dying. You'd tell me if you were dying, right?

DAD. Probably not. Now just sit down and watch me do my work. You may want to take notes.

JIMMY. I really don't think I'll need to—

DAD. You need to. There's a lot of detail that goes into psychology!

JIMMY. Yeah, but—

DAD. No buts. Never buts. Make sure you pay attention, okay? All right, let's get started with my first patient of the day, one Mister, uh… huh. Mister Sniffles. What a fun name!

(A cat enters, sits across from Dad.)

DAD. Good afternoon, Mister Sniffles. First of all, I hope you don't mind that my son observes our session. He's a therapist in training. Now it says here you are working through some detachment issues. What is it you're detached from?

(The cat meows.)

DAD. I see.

JIMMY. Oh, my.

DAD. And when was the last time you saw this ball of yarn?

(The cat thinks, then meows.)

DAD. I see, I see. Well, six minutes is a long time to go without a toy.

JIMMY. Dad, this is so stupid!

DAD. This is not stupid, Jimmy. You're stupid!

JIMMY. Hey!

DAD. I didn't mean that. You know me. I'm rubber you're glue—the way it's always been. Now let me continue my work. *(to the cat)* Tell me about your parents.

JIMMY. Dad, it's a cat! It can't talk!

DAD. SHHH! Jimmy, he can hear you! I'm so sorry, Mr. Sniffles. This is so unprofessional.

JIMMY. He doesn't care about professionalism because HE'S A CAT! Can't you understand that? You can't be a psychologist to a creature that can't speak.

DAD. All right then, Mr. Sniffles. I'm sorry, but it appears we need to reschedule our session for next week.

(The cat meows sadly.)

DAD. I know. I am ashamed of him. Goodbye for now! Make sure to write in your thought journal every evening.

JIMMY. Look, Dad, I know you really care about your job, and you want me to follow in your footsteps…

DAD. (*to JIMMY)* Hold it, why don't you hold it right there.

JIMMY. Let me finish—

DAD. I will not let you finish because I don't like what you're going to say.

JIMMY. So? I still need to say it!

DAD. Well I don't want to hear it!

JIMMY. Well too bad!

DAD. *(plugs ears)* La la la la la la la…

JIMMY. I don't want to be a pet psychologist, Dad!

DAD. Wow. Even the innocent game of 'la la la' couldn't drown out your defiance.

JIMMY. Look, it's just…it's not for me!

DAD. Oh, really. And how do you know? Huh? Have you ever tried it?

JIMMY. Of course not.

DAD. Exactly!

JIMMY. Animals can't talk, Dad! People pay you to just sit and make up elaborate stories about how sad their pets are.

DAD. Oh, right. Like I just made up how sad that horse was to get his mane clipped.

JIMMY. Yes! You made that up! I don't understand how you could be so delusional.

DAD. You don't understand, huh? Well then today is your lucky day, Jimmy-boy!

JIMMY. No day is ever my lucky day.

DAD. I guess this is your first one!

JIMMY. I doubt that.

DAD. Go on up to your room. I've got a surprise waiting for you!

JIMMY. Really?

DAD. Would I lie to you?

JIMMY. Yes.

DAD. Well, go up there anyway.

JIMMY. Fine. I was going to go up there even before you told me to.

DAD. Fine.

JIMMY. Great!

(JIMMY heads upstairs and enters his room.)

JIMMY. Okay, uh, what's the big surprise?

DAD. Let me see…Where did I put that? Oh, here it is!

(DAD picks up a puppy and tosses it into Jimmy's arms.)

JIMMY. Oh my god, you got me a puppy?

DAD. For the next hour I did!

JIMMY. (*nervously suspicious)* You better mean you're renting it for an hour.

DAD. He's your first patient!

JIMMY. Dad.

DAD. Be careful, he's bipolar.

(Dad exits. Jimmy stares at the puppy.)

JIMMY. Great. What, now I've got to sit here with this puppy for an hour? What do I do, huh? Just talk to you like I'm a crazy person? So tell me, Mister Wigglesworth, what's been bothering you lately? Not enough doggie treats? Can't catch your tail? Huh? What's the matter?

DOG. My neighbor's cat!

JIMMY. (*shocked)* Uh. Um. Uh. Uh. Um. What?

DOG. I don't like cats. They're scary! My neighbor's cat came all the way to the window yesterday. It was RUFF!

JIMMY. Are... Are you talking to me right now?

DOG. Of course! I paid a lot of bones for this. Can't let my bones go to waste! I *love* bones.

JIMMY. Don't you usually just bury bones anyway?

DOG. Exactly, now I need more bones.

JIMMY. All right, look... I don't know why you can talk to me. I'm sorry, but I'm not a pet therapist.

DOG. Uh-bugh?! You're no shrink?

JIMMY. I'm really sorry. Does this help?

(Jimmy uncomfortably pats the dog on the head.)

DOG. Yes, but I still want my bones back!

JIMMY. You'll have to take that up with my receptionist.

DOG. *(barking)* Who?

JIMMY. My Dad.

DOG. Bones!

JIMMY. Yes, yes bones.

DOG. I'm leaving now. You should know that though my tail is wagging, I am only mildly happy right now.

JIMMY. I'm sorry. Again.

(DOG leaves. DAD enters.)

DAD. What did you do? That dog left more hysterical than when he came in!

JIMMY. It's a dog! He probably just went too long without sniffing a butt or something.

DAD. So did he tell you anything interesting in here?

JIMMY. What? No, he's a dog! He didn't tell me anything...

DAD. So you couldn't communicate with him?

JIMMY. Not much past polite licking.

DAD. That's odd. Maybe I was wrong. Maybe you aren't meant for this business.

JIMMY. Yes! Thank you, Dad! See? When you just apply a little logic—

DAD. But let's not get ahead of ourselves, shall we? Here. Try this next patient!

(DAD throws a hawk at Jimmy.)

JIMMY. Did you just throw a hawk at me?

(HAWK screeches)

JIMMY. Help! Somebody, please! This hawk's going to destroy me!

HAWK. I beg your pardon?

JIMMY. Oh…you…have….*got* to be kidding me.

HAWK. Not kidding. I rarely kid, just ask the fish that! *(laughs)*

JIMMY. What?

HAWK. Get it? Because I eat fish? Oh, never mind.

JIMMY. Good thing you're not trying to be a comedian.

HAWK. Oh, but I am. It's just that lately I've been having so much trouble concentrating. There's a problem.

JIMMY. You have a problem, too? How can all of these animals have such emotional turmoil? What, is there too little responsibility for you guys? Too much freedom?

HAWK. I beg your pardon! Just because we're animals doesn't mean we don't have problems.

JIMMY. Oh, really? What's wrong? The ability to fly is too awesome for you?

HAWK. Are you familiar with the phrase "the early bird gets the worm"?

JIMMY. Yes, of course.

HAWK. I'm not a morning person.

JIMMY. And *that's* why you need to see a shrink? Because you don't wake up early enough, and the other birds eat the worms?

HAWK. It's quite frustrating.

JIMMY. They're worms!

HAWK. Which is an essential part of my diet! I like to snooze and wake up in the afternoon. Sure, I can eat as many fish as I want. But fish, *every day*? For the rest of my life? Variety, Jimmy. Variety is the spice of life.

JIMMY. This is so stupid. You can catch a lot of fish, right?

HAWK. Indubitably.

JIMMY. Why don't you just partner up with another hawk who *does* wake up early and you can do some sort of trade-deal kind of thing? They give you worms; you give them fish.

HAWK. That… (*ponders)* That could actually work. My boy, I think you've done it! You're absolutely brilliant—a savior to modern society! *(calling out)* Dear friends, Jimmy is amazing! Come speak with him!

(A flood of animals surges into Jimmy's room.)

JIMMY. Wait, who are you? Why are all of these animals in my room? A turtle?

TURTLE. I was hoping you could help me break out of my emotional shell.

JIMMY. A bunny?

RABBIT. Um. UM. Excuse me! I'm a rabbit, not a bunny. That's like super ignorant.

Editor's Note: Pages 18 and 19 of the print editon are the ad on the next page.

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JIMMY. And there's even a (*beat)* well, I can't even tell what kind of animal you are.

SALAMANDER. Salamander! *(slurps)*

JIMMY. Wow. And you all came to see me?

TURTLE. Of course, Jimmy! You're our only chance! You have a rare gift, indeed. We need you!

RABBIT. Yeah, you're like...super special.

SALAMANDER. I'm a salamander! (*slurps*)

JIMMY. So after all these years of my dad talking to animals, after all the ridicule I got at school and the constant embarrassment, he really could talk to you guys?

TURTLE. Of course! You couldn't hear the animals talk back because of doctor-patient confidentiality. It didn't mean we weren't talking.

RABBIT. We can be, like, super chatty with people we let talk to us.

TURTLE. It's true.

SALAMANDER. Yes!

JIMMY. I think I'm going to be sick.

RABBIT. Ew.

TURTLE. Why?

SALAMANDER. Bad bug?

JIMMY. No, it's just the feeling humans get when they have to apologize.

TURTLE. Oh, I get that feeling whenever I'm challenged to a race.

(*JIMMY stares skeptically at TURTLE. TURTLE stares back. A moment passes.)*

TURTLE. I'm just kidding, that doesn't actually happen.

RABBIT. Like you'd ever even win.

TURTLE. What I lack in flash I make up for in determination!

SALAMANDER. Salamander!

JIMMY. Okay, guys, I've got to go do something. I'll be right back.

(JIMMY goes downstairs, walks up to his dad.)

JIMMY. Hey dad, I—

DAD. That hawk you were talking to sure left in a hurry. Did you mentally scar him, too?

JIMMY. No.

DAD. Because I swear, if you touched one feather on that innocent hawk's head—

JIMMY. (*interrupts)* Dad, stop. He left in a hurry because...I kind of...this is so embarrassing.

DAD. Say it!

JIMMY. Do I have to?

DAD. If you don't spill the beans, you are grounded for the rest of this lifetime!

JIMMY. I helped him.

DAD. You...You what?

JIMMY. I helped him.

DAD. Really?

JIMMY. Yeah.

DAD. Can I hear it one more time?

JIMMY. No, I'm good.

DAD. Please?

JIMMY. Dad.

DAD. Okay. Wow. You helped your first animal! Son, you *are* my son!

(DAD pulls him into a hug, which JIMMY slides out of.)

JIMMY. Why didn't you tell me that we actually could talk to animals? That would've been good to know a really, really long time ago.

DAD. Well you can't just talk to any animal, they have to want to talk to you! Animals are very high maintenance creatures. That's why they poop in such neat little piles, unlike myself.

JIMMY. Yeah, I noticed…on both accounts. Well, I guess I should (*reluctant)…* I don't want to say this either.

DAD. Say it! Say it!

JIMMY. (*sighs)* I apologize for doubting you.

DAD. Can I hear it again?

JIMMY. No!

DAD. Fine.

JIMMY. I guess I should even thank you.

DAD. Wait, really?

JIMMY. Without you pushing me towards pet therapy, I never would've discovered what are pretty awesome special powers. I mean, I can talk to animals! How crazy is that?

DAD. Almost as crazy as me!

JIMMY. I wouldn't go that far.

DAD. Okay.

JIMMY. Thanks, dad.

DAD. You're welcome, son. What do you say we go to the pet store and see what rumors are going around? I've been hearing whispers of a pretty promiscuous squirrel.

JIMMY. All right, Dad, Sure. Let's...(*sighs)* I can't even say it.

DAD. Say it! Say it!

JIMMY. Do I have to?

DAD. Yes!

JIMMY. Fine. Let's go talk to some animals.

DAD. The family business lives on!

Wretched

by James Cronan

MUNCHKIN #1. Look, it's Glennda! (*GLENNDA appears humming. Musical transitions are encouraged in the performance.)*
GLENNDA. Fellow Ahhzians, the Wretched Witch of the West is dead!
MUNCHKIN #2. Is it true? Is the Wretched Witch of the West really dead?
GLENNDA. Yes, I just said that.
MUNCHKIN #3. Oooh! I have a question! Was she born wretched?
GLENNDA. Well, let me think…

FLASH BACK
MIDWIFE. Here she is. A lovely baby, is it not?
ALPHALBAH. (*growls)*
MIDWIFE. Yes, baby is lovely, no?

FLASH FORWARD
GLENNDA. She wasn't lovely, not at all.
MUNCHKIN #1. Weren't you her friend, Glennda?
GLENNDA. Well, to answer that, we'll have to go back to the beginning. It all started at school, where I met the Wretched Witch of the West — I mean — Alphalbah.

TRANSITION
HORRIBLE. Hello, students! I am Madame Horrible, headmistress here at Haugwurtz, I mean Whiz…(*HORRIBLE picks up the magic chalk that has written her name on the board.)* …Thank you, magic, University. *(She puts the chalk in her mouth and transforms it into gum.)* Mmm, chalky! School will be hard but fun and…(*sees ALPHALBAH)* Sweet Ahhz! You're a green child!
ALPHALBAH. Yes, I am.
HORRIBLE. Are you seasick?
ALPHALBAH. No, I'm just green.
HORRIBLE. Are you an artichoke?
ALPHALBAH. No, I'm not a vegetable.
HORRIBLE. Is your skin an outward manifestation of your twisted and evil nature?
ALPHALBAH. No, it's not my fault! I can't help that I can magically teleport! (*poofs)*
HORRIBLE. Impressive.
ALPHALBAH. Or that I can make objects move! (*moves)*
HORRIBLE. Astonishing!
ALPHALBAH. Or that I can say the entire alphabet backwards. (*prepares to do so, is interrupted)*
HORRIBLE. Witchcraft!

ALPHALBAH. And I can't help it that I'm green!
HORRIBLE. Well, to be fair, you do look like an artichoke. Oh, relax. Don't be so sensitive. I'm just kidding! Now I want everyone to take out their essays "Magic Wands, What's the Point?" Ouch! (*laughs)* Apparently, the point is very sharp. (*bell rings*) Oh, that's the bell! Hand in your essays and have fun at your next class!
ALPHALBAH. Okay, teleport to Doctor Diamond's class! (*poofs)*

TRANSITION
GLENNDA. Alphalbah was learning how difficult it was to be herself. Her teachers were not very understanding or kind to her, and neither were her peers.
MUNCHKIN #1. How do you know?
GLENNDA. Well, because *I* was not very nice to her.

TRANSITION
ALPHALBAH. Dr. Diamond's class.
DIAMOND. Hello, I am Dr. Diamond, your token goat teacher at Whiz University.
GLENNDA. Umm, excuse me, have you read our most recent essays?
DIAMOND. You must be Glinda.
GLENNDA. NO. It's Glennda, with an 'e.' I don't want to get sued.
DIAMOND. That's a long name. Well, Glennda-with-an-e-I-don't-want-to-get-sued, where is your essay?
GLENNDA. Here it is. (*hands it to him*)
DIAMOND. (*eats it*) It wasn't baaad. You get a C.
GLENNDA. What do you mean a C? Ewwwww!
DIAMOND. Ewe? Where? Hubba Hubba.
GLENNDA. Goats are so bad at grading papers!
DIAMOND. You're next, ugly.
ALPHALBAH. It's Alphalbah, actually.
DIAMOND. (*eats it*) Mmmmm, A-plus.
GLENNDA. Ugh. I don't understand what the problem is. None of the other professors seem to be having difficulty pronouncing my name.
ALPHALBAH. Listen, Glennda, maybe pronouncing your precious name isn't the only purpose of Doctor Diamond's life. Maybe this is how Doctor Diamond teaches. Maybe he has a different style. Maybe he's (*beat)* different.
GLENNDA. Ok, Alfalfa, shush. I'm trying to learn good. It's hard with you sprouting up all up in my super cute face.
ALPHALBAH. It's Alphalbah! Why are you pronouncing my name wrong when YOU hate that yourself!
DIAMOND. I agree with the girl who doesn't want legal trouble, be quiet, ugly! You're really getting my goat. Class dismissed. Tomorrow, I will collect more delicious essays.
ALPHALBAH. All right, to Madame Horrible's again.

TRANSITION

GLENNDA. I felt horribly about what I had done.

MUNCHKIN #3. What did you do?

GLENNDA. Luckily, Madame Horrible came up with a solution so that I could make it up to Alphalbah.

TRANSITION

ALPHALBAH. Madame Horrible!

HORRIBLE. Sweet greens-us!

ALPHALBAH. Madame Horrible, I have a secret. (*pause)* I have no friends.

HORRIBLE. Oh, that's not a secret. At least you're very bright. Why, you practically glow in the dark. Do something magical.

ALPHALBAH. Okay. (*She does something magical.)*

HORRIBLE. That was astonishing!

ALPHALBAH. Sorry, sometimes something just comes over me.

HORRIBLE. What? No, never apologize for your gifts! I could never do that. Oh! I have an idea. Never mind my rules about favoritism! You're remarkable. I shall teach you myself! But you'll need a partner. If you see Glennda, give her this training wand.

ALPHALBAH. Really? Thank you. Off to Glennda's house!

TRANSITION

ALPHALBAH. Glennda!

GLENNDA. Ahh! Don't do that!

ALPHALBAH: Here, Glennda. Madame Horrible wanted me to give you this wand. She says we should be partners.

GLENNDA. Partners? Even after I was so mean to you? Oh my Whiz, now we can be best friends! Me, the sparkling leader of tomorrow, and you, the tragedy. I'm going to make you over and fix you up!

ALPHALBAH. You don't have to do that.

GLENNDA. Yes, I do. I really do. Oh Alphabet, Your whole life is going to be different because of me, and makeup…so much makeup. Okay, let's fix all of this! (*She attempts to use magic to fix ALPHALBAH'S face, but she fails.)* Well, that didn't work. How about you wear this hat? It's black, like your personality.

ALPHALBAH. No one…no one has ever given me anything before.

GLENNDA. Oh, and look at you. You…you…well, you're wearing a hat, yay! Can I ask you a question?

ALPHALBAH. Sure.

GLENNDA. Your skin is a different color.

ALPHALBAH. That isn't a question.

GLENNDA. Oh, right. Why is your skin a different color? Is your father a Teenage Mutant Ninja Turtle?

ALPHALBAH. I'm not quite sure, but I'm treated differently because of my skin color. It isn't easy being green.

GLENNDA. I'm sorry to hear that. I've never thought about it like that before.

(*her phone*) Madame Horrible! Yes, Alpha-Centari's right here. (*As she sets it down, HORRIBLE appears.*)

HORRIBLE. Oh El-Phelaphant, I've told the Whizard about your condition and your magical abilities and he wants to meet you!

ALPHALBAH. The Whizard, what? I'm so excited I could just melt!

GLENNDA. Not on the carpet, please. Mother just had them cleaned.

HORRIBLE. When the Whizard is done with you, people will scream in a different way.

ALPHALBAH. Glennda, let's go to the City of Emeralds! Together.

GLENNDA. I've always wanted to go there!

ALPHALBAH. Okay. Let's go to the Whizard's room!

TRANSITION

GLENNDA. (*talking to the munchkins*) Alphalbah had forgiven me, but we had no idea of the frightening and terrifying task that lay ahead!

MUNCHKIN #1. Was it a spelling test?

MUNCHKIN #2. Oh, no! Spelling is hard.

GLENNDA. No, and quit interrupting.

TRANSITION

WHIZARD. I am the great and mighty Ahhhz. (*WHIZARD suddenly changes.)* Just kidding, I'm the "great" Ahhhz. Now let's see, which witch is which? I'm so cute. Alphalbah, you have come to prove yourself with this, the ancient spell book of spells. Oooh. Try a flying spell on my monkey servant.

MONKEY #1. (*grunts)*

GLENNDA. Awwwww. Oh, look at all its cute hair all over its face. It looks just like you, Alf.

ALPHALBAH. Thanks. Okay. Flying spell. Avardahkedaverahhhh!

MONKEY: (*The monkey dies.*)

WHIZARD. Oh, my. Um. (*He looks at the book.)* Oh! That was a dying spell, not a flying spell. (*laughs)* Oh, silly poor eyesight. (*calls out)* I NEED ANOTHER MONKEY! Try again, dear.

ALPHALBAH. All right. Boop!

MONKEY #2. (*He grows wings.*)

WHIZARD. Perfect! A flying monkey, he'll make a wonderful spy. They can fly around and report any shady activity to me and fight my battles without me leaving this room. I shall call them drone monkeys. (*hesitates)* I mean, flying monkeys.

ALPHALBAH. Wait a minute. You lied to me!

WHIZARD. Only verbally. But my dear, I think you know too much. I'm going to tell everyone in Ahhz that this was your plan and that YOU are wretched! Destroying you will be a…whiz. (*He laughs.)* I'm so cute.

ALPHALBAH. Let's get the Alph out of here!

TRANSITION

ALPHALBAH. Phew.

GLENNDA. Alpha-dog, you saved my life.

ALPHALBAH. Yeah, but the Whizard shouldn't be allowed to do this. Why would he want to lie to everyone? He can't use his power this way.

GLENNDA. That's the way it is in Ahhhz.

ALPHALBAH. I just don't understand why the Whizard doing this! Why is everyone so mean to me? All I have ever done is what people have told me! I don't hurt anyone, and I'm not mean to anyone.

GLENNDA. Alpha, I'm sorry you're treated differently.

ALPHALBAH. No. This—all of this—is wrong. I have to go; I have to fix this because the Whizard is the wicked one. So, I guess this is goodbye.

GLENNDA. I'm going to miss this. Standing next to you made me look even prettier.

ALPHALBAH. Glennda, you know I only have one friend? You.

GLENNDA. And I have so so so so so so so so many. But you're the only one that ever mattered, Alphalbah. Tear.

ALPHALBAH. You, too, and don't worry about me, Glennda. Nobody, in all of Ahhhz, no Whizard, then or now, nobody, is ever going to take me down!

TRANSITION

MUNCHKIN #1. And then what happened?

GLENNDA. A little girl threw water on her and she melted. The end.

MUNCHKIN #2. What? That is a terrible story!

GLENNDA. No, she was my friend, I loved her, and I grew because I knew her. I'm changed.

MUNCHKIN #2. No, this story is not really all that fulfilling. Tell us the one about the girl who lost her slipper. That sounds nice.

GLENNDA. Oh, you are so small-minded! *(She uses magic to make MUNCHKIN #2 disappear.)* Oh, my. That was rather wicked of me.

MUNCHKIN #3. You know, Glennda, that was a really good story.

MUNCHKIN #1. Yes, that was a magically good story!

GLENNDA. Yes, you might say it was wickedly good.

Moonraker vs. High School

by Matt Mills

(MOONRAKER sits at her bedroom desk, opens up a diary, and begins writing.)

MOONRAKER. Dear diary…

DIARY. What now, Moonraker?

MOONRAKER. (*startled)* Ah! I told you to not interrupt me like that! You know how much I love the sound of my voice.

DIARY. You and no one else.

MOONRAKER. Whatever, I'm perfect and you're boring. Get over it. Okay, so here we go. Dear diary…

DIARY. Why must you address everything to me? Don't you have any friends?

MOONRAKER. *(pause)* Uh…

DIARY. Oh, that's right. I forgot. Well, why don't you give me some rest and write some letters instead, hm? Go and be a pen pal to some inmates, or befriend some strangers in an online chatroom.

MOONRAKER. If I could get inmates to write me back, don't you think I would have done that by now?

DIARY. Fair point.

MOONRAKER. So just shut up and listen to me because no one else will, okay? Today was super stressful—you don't even know!

DIARY. Oh, no. Your life is so hard what with all the algebra and eating pudding and whatnot. (*mocking)* Blah blah blah…

MOONRAKER. Pudding? I can only dream about pudding! (*beat)* Do you have any pudding?

DIARY. Just get on with your self-pitying story so we can be over with already. I'm tired.

MOONRAKER. You're so right for once. We should listen to me. Okay, back to the story-ory-oh. Well, junior high graduation is tomorrow. Right now everyone is forming friend groups so that when we get to high school, our cliques will already be formed and in pique clique mode! The only problem is that nobody has asked me to come to their ceremonial 'post-junior-high-graduation-party-that's-an-initiation-for-high-school-friend-cliques' parties.

DIARY. *(bored)* Oh, wow. I can't believe it.

MOONRAKER. Isn't that some horse pooey?! Nobody wants me in their friend group! *Me*! Stupid Bethany from the stupid popular group of stupids said…

(Flashback to the junior high school...)

BETHANY. Ha. Ha. Hahahaha, *you* want to come to *my* party?

MOONRAKER. No, your party wants to come to me.

BETHANY. It really doesn't, believe me.

MOONRAKER. How would you know? Did you ask it?

BETHANY. Did I ask my party if it wants to go to you?
MOONRAKER. Bethany, ugh you're so slow…like a pretty sloth.
BETHANY. You're stupid. Did someone hit you in the brain a lot as a kid?
MOONRAKER. No.
BETHANY. Why not?
CHAD. Hey Bethany! I football hockey lacrosse-skied your curling gymnastics bobsled team. Looking mixed martial arts to it.
MOONRAKER. Did you just have a stroke, dude?
BETHANY. Oh my god, I can't believe you just talked to Chad that way!
MOONRAKER. Who?
BETHANY. Oh my god, do you not know who Chad is?
CHAD. Do you track golf competitive cheerleading I am?!
MOONRAKER. I'm getting super creeped out guys.
BETHANY. Chad is going to be the star quarterback of our high school football sport team thing. I don't really know, but he's so good at sports things that 98% of his vocabulary is just names of sports.
MOONRAKER. That's not a real thing.
BETHANY. It is, and it's so cute. Right, Chad?
CHAD. *(nods)* Bowling.
BETHANY. He's so hot!
MOONRAKER. If you find the Wikipedia page entitled 'List of Sports' attractive, then sure it is.
CHAD. BMX, babe. BMX.
BETHANY. Yeah I know, she totally smells like boiled onions.
CHAD. Table tennis kayak!
BETHANY. Oh my god, you did not just go there!
MOONRAKER. What? Chad!
BETHANY. Wow, you really are super super lame. Have fun having no friends in high school, Dunetaker.
MOONRAKER. Hey! My name's Moonraker! And I *will* have fun having no friends in high school!
BETHANY. Good comeback, Junefaker.
CHAD. Rowing basketball racing!
BETHANY. *(laughing)* Oh my god, totally!
MOONRAKER. Dang it, Chad. That was a good burn. You're both too blind to see that I am the coolest person in the universe and every other friend group in this place will be dying to have me!
BETHANY. Will they?
MOONRAKER. They will.

(End of flashback.)
DIARY. Did they?
MOONRAKER. They did not.

(Flash forward to the school cafeteria…)
BRAD. Why is your face twitching?

MOONRAKER. *(twitches)* What? I don't find you super attracti… I'm not twitching!
BRAD. Ok, whatever, girl who's creeping me out. What do you want? The Snack Pack's off limits.
MOONRAKER. Dang it! I mean… I'm not over here for any reason. No hidden agenda. *(suddenly)* Can I be in your high school friend group?
BRAD. Can pigs fly over the moon?
MOONRAKER. If launched within a fully manned American space shuttle they can!
BRAD. No. Now leave me alone. Awesome, thanks…
(MOONRAKER pouts then rushes over to another table.)
MOONRAKER. Sylvia, can I join your friend group?
SYLVIA. Like, like like like like like like, like no.
MOONRAKER. Like a jerk, you jerk-face-killah. Ok, uh…Ron?
RON. I have a restraining order. Step away!
MOONRAKER. Oh, yes. That's right. Again, sorry about that, and sorry to your dog. Rest in peace.
(RON cries and runs off. MOONRAKER looks around; only GERTRON'S group is left, unfortunately.)
MOONRAKER. Hey, Gertron!
GERTRON. Ah, me!
MOONRAKER. Yeah, you. Stop drooling over how hot I am; this is very serious business. If you are interested, I would kindly grant to you my presence in your geeky high school friend group.
GERTRON. You want to be part of our friend group?
MOONRAKER. Yeahhh, Gerty! The Gertster! El Gertron-o—
GERTRON. Please stop that.
MOONRAKER. The point is, we go way back!
GERTRON. No, we don't.
MOONRAKER. But don't you think we should?
GERTRON. What do we have in common, Moonraker?
MOONRAKER. We (*searches for answer)* both like…food! Right?
GERTRON. No. I don't like food.
MOONRAKER. *(silences her rage)* Okay. You like math, right?
GERTRON. Yeah, but I know you don't.
MOONRAKER. How would you know something like that? Pervert!
GERTRON. You told our geometry teacher that the only thing you didn't hate about her class was hearing about 'pi' every day.
MOONRAKER. Oh, come on, Gertle. Gertsy-bertsy. I was just kidding! I love lots of maths and stuffs of them sorts.
GERTRON. Really?
MOONRAKER. Really!
GERTRON. X minus five equals five. X is…
MOONRAKER. Pi!
GERTRON. What is four hundred times two?
MOONRAKER. Pi!

GERTRON. If a train leaves Washington at noon—
MOONRAKER. Strawberry pi!
GERTRON. To calculate the circumference of a circle, you would use…
MOONRAKER. Vanilla bean crème brulée!
GERTRON. (*rolls eyes)* You'll never be mathematically proficient enough to hang with us cool cats. Gertster and the Cosine Boys, out!
MOONRAKER. *(to herself)* The Gertster! I knew it.

(Back in MOONRAKER'S bedroom…)
DIARY. So nobody wanted you in their friend group? Whah whah. You're sad. Can I go to bed now?
MOONRAKER. Okay, one: no. And two: no. Three—
DIARY. Are you finished?
MOONRAKER. No, I am not, yet, up to this point, finished.
DIARY. When will you finally go see a psychiatrist?
MOONRAKER. Right after this story!
DIARY. Hurry then!
MOONRAKER. You got it! So I was in school without a friend group but then all of a sudden, *(pause) Bethany* came up to me and was all like…

(Back to the cafeteria…)
BETHANY. Hey, Moonraker. If you want you can, like, come to our party tonight, or whatever, I guess. It's your call.
MOONRAKER. Wowza howza, did you just say those words? With your mouth? And lips?
BETHANY. Yeah-duh, how else?
MOONRAKER. Does this mean I can be in your super awesome fun happy-time friend group?
BETHANY. Geez, chill out, we'll see. But I totally sorta but really actually do promise that we will definitely maybe but really absolutely let you join our friend group.
MOONRAKER. *(calculating)* I think I'm happy?
BETHANY. Just show up at 8. Don't be late. Don't be lame.
MOONRAKER. You have got yourself a deal there, broseph. Oh god, please shut me up.
BETHANY. Yeah. Please.
DIARY. Well that's nice. You went to the party and had fun, and it's time to go to bed, yes? Okay good—
MOONRAKER. Okay, diary. You have got to get up out of my business before I write the wrong version of "your" all over ***you are*** face!
DIARY. No! You wouldn't dare!
MOONRAKER. Oh, I'd dare.
DIARY. Ah!
MOONRAKER. I'd dare you super duper hard.
DIARY. Please, just tell us whatever you need to and don't vandalize my body with moronic grammar!

MOONRAKER. *(joyful)* Yay! Okay, so I showed up at the party, and it was, like, super fun…

(Transition to BETHANY'S basement, which is in full party-mode. MOONRAKER goofily dances in.)
MOONRAKER. Bethany, hi hi hi! Hi, I'm here!
BETHANY. Oh my god, why do you smell like old salami?
MOONRAKER. Yeah, right. Like you're not also susceptible to the tempting desires of cured meats!
BETHANY. No. I'm not.
MOONRAKER. This party is supes-dupes awesome, 'nam'sayin'?
BETHANY. What?
MOONRAKER. 'nam—
BETHANY. Why are you saying "nam"?
MOONRAKER. You 'na'namsayin'?
BETHANY. Hey, Moonraker. I have an idea.
CHAD. I also women's field hockey and tennis!
BETHANY. Why don't you go in the closet with this cute little loaf right here for a fun game of "Seven Minutes in Heaven"? Or do you think you're too hot for him?
MOONRAKER. Well, it would be kind of reaching below my league, but…okay!
CHAD. Water polo badminton?
MOONRAKER. Holy smokes, Chad, yes! Water polo badminton, let's go!

(MOONRAKER rushes them into the closet.)
MOONRAKER. Oh, man. I'm so excited I'm shaking! Don't you have that too? Like, body earthquakes? Body-quakes! Quaker's Body Oats… Bodyof…
CHAD. Uh…
MOONRAKER. Body By Quaker.
CHAD. Why don't you surfboard close your white water rafting eyes?
MOONRAKER. Uh…oh! Close my eyes? Wait. You're gonna kiss me now? Oh, man… *(closes her eyes)* This is just like in that Freddie Prinze Jr. movie! Only I don't have glasses. And your hair's not as pretty, and what was with that one guy—
(CHAD approaches with a bucket in his hands…)
CHAD. Keep your spelling bee eyes closed! I'm archery not gonna throw any dirty ice bath on you or anything.
MOONRAKER. This is so romantic, holy butt! Oh, my grandma, this is too much, it's too much, it's too—
(A look of horror washes over MOONRAKER'S face. CHAD freezes right before pouring the dirty ice on her.)
CHAD. Wait. Did you…just…
MOONRAKER. Uh… I…
CHAD. Ah, it burns!
MOONRAKER. It doesn't smell that…
CHAD. Ow! Ow! Oh, my go. She farted! She farted! Guys! She

BASEketballed! Ewww!

BETHANY. *(rushing in)* She did WHAT?!

(The smell hits BETHANY.)

BETHANY. Oh, my god. It's like a plague!

MOONRAKER. Come on guys, it's not that—

CHAD. Run, hundred yard dash, run!

(Back to MOONRAKER'S bedroom…)

MOONRAKER. So, yeah. It was not the best of nights. I kind of ruined my reputation…for the rest of my life.

DIARY. But hey…at least…uh…you…uh…

MOONRAKER. I didn't die?

DIARY. You didn't die. So, there! It's a happy ending. All done here. Good night! Please let the bed bugs bite—

MOONRAKER. No, wait! There's more!

DIARY. Oh, please, somebody kill me!

MOONRAKER. So I went home that night super sad and emotional but still pretty hot looking.

(Transition to MOONRAKER running down the street, rushing inside her house. She collects herself.)

MOONRAKER. Mom, I need the ice cream! NOW!

(We hear a 'tink' at her window.)

MOONRAKER. Oh, great. Now people are throwing rocks at my house.

(MOONRAKER begins opening the door, raising her fist.)

MOONRAKER. Go home, you bird-poop-brained, pimple-headed—

GERTRON. Whoa whoa whoa, Moonraker! It's me!

MOONRAKER. Gertrude?

GERTRON. It's Gertron.

MOONRAKER. Teflon?

GERTRON. *(pause)* Sure. Look, Moonraker, I need to tell you something.

MOONRAKER. You think I'm a major babe, and you want to hold my hand?

GERTRON. Precisely!

MOONRAKER. Wait. What…

GERTRON. As I analyzed the course of my day during my scheduled Gertron-thinks-about-his-day time, I began to realize that I had been pushing you away so strongly because I was defensive about my own feelings towards you.

MOONRAKER. Uh. Wow, so…you…

GERTRON. I want you to join my high school friend group.

MOONRAKER. Wow. Wow. (*long beat)* Wow. Okay, so first of all…duh, who *wouldn't* have feelings for me? I'm awesome. Second, thanks but no thanks.

GERTRON. You don't want to be in my friend group, entitled "Math Stars of Millardton West, Yo!"?

MOONRAKER. No. And no. I just…as I was looking back on my day, I began to

realize that I am a genius, and a superstar. I am also really good looking, but we'll come back to that later. See, I don't fit in with a lot of people, and that's okay. I'm a lone wolf in a school of measly sheep, and I am going to…give, them all…the measles.

GERTRON. Uh….

MOONRAKER. No—

GERTRON. That's biological warfare…

MOONRAKER. I didn't mean it like that. I just mean… Please get off my porch, Gertron. I'm better than you.

GERTRON. No…No, I love—

MOONRAKER. Bye!

(She slams the door, transition to her bedroom…)

DIARY. *(Snores.)*

MOONRAKER. So, yeah! Wasn't that crazy?

(DIARY continues snoring.)

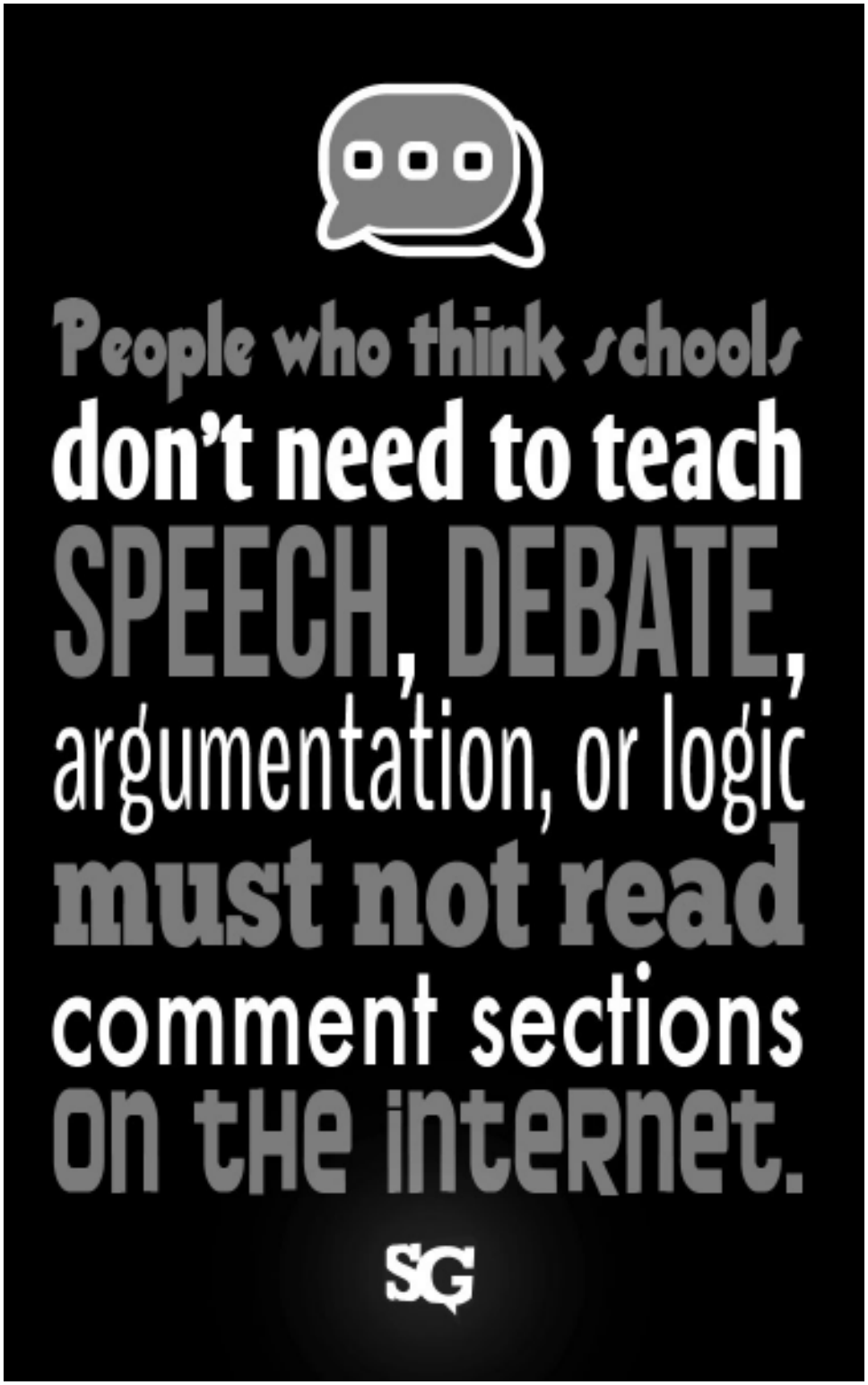
MOONRAKER. So, yeah, it was a pretty good day.

(DIARY continues snoring.)

MOONRAKER. Pretty good day!

(DIARY snores angrily.)

MOONRAKER. Fine. Guess it's time for bed. I'll just say that high school is going to be an awesome four years of Moonraker-awesomeness! Awe somely awesome. Okay. Good night. See you tomorrow, and sweet dreams! Moonraker, out!



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SpeechGeek
248 Arlington Park Dr.
Hot Springs, AR 71901
thegeek@speechgeek.com

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